

Earlier appointments, less chasing

A proposal for Lena and Carla

Today, a Google Sheet and manual texts make it hard to track replies and remember the next person. Empty chairs cost the salon an opportunity to serve a client.

Texting several people at once has also left two clients believing they had the same appointment.

LENA'S GOAL

50%+

of last-minute cancellations
refilled, without repeated staff
checking

The priority

Keep offers moving reliably and
avoid promising the same opening
twice.

An opening, from review to acceptance

01 Staff review the matches

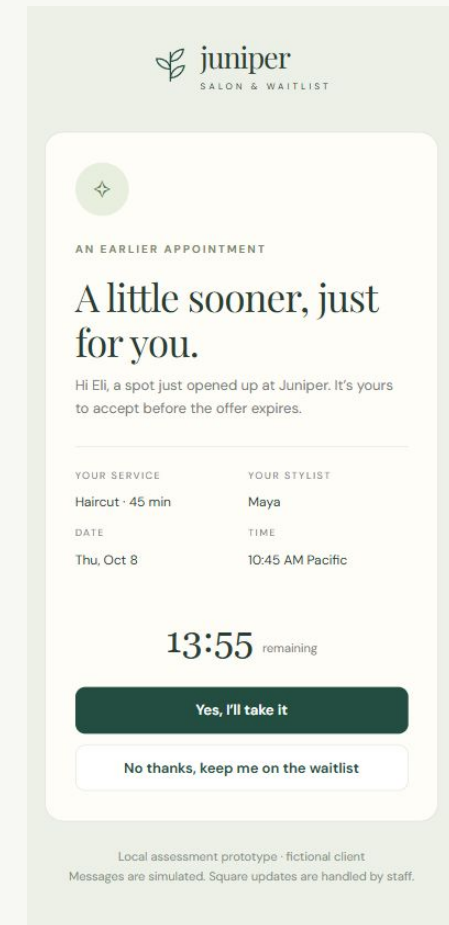
Match service, required stylist, full availability, and duration. Earliest joined comes first. Remove unsuitable candidates and approve contact now.

02 One client gets the offer

The phone page shows service, stylist, date and time. The client has 15 minutes to accept or decline.

03 The queue moves or the opening fills

Decline, timeout, or failed delivery moves to the next client. Acceptance holds the opening and ends outreach. Staff update Square manually.



Actual prototype client page

Declining keeps a client on the waitlist. Accepting removes that entry from consideration for other openings.

Reliable follow-up, even after an interruption

Temporal remembers the offer and its deadline

Temporal saves progress if the background service stops. When it restarts, overdue offers expire using their original deadlines and the queue resumes. Closing a browser does not stop the process.

The first valid acceptance gets the opening

Only the current, unexpired offer can win. Old links cannot claim it. A client can accept only one opening from their waitlist entry.

Staff can stop outreach

Canceling closes pending links and stops new offers. If the service cannot confirm a response, the page must not promise a booking.

What this prototype does today

Working locally

Staff see the current offer, remaining clients, and timestamped outcomes. Outreach ends when someone accepts, staff cancel, candidates run out, or the appointment starts.

Temporal runs the queue and timers. Client pages accept or decline. The demo can shorten the 15-minute window to 20 seconds.

Simulated or excluded

Texts and notifications appear in a demo inbox. No real SMS goes out. Client records and phone numbers are fictional.

Staff still update Square, including the original appointment. Google Sheets and the full stylist calendar are not connected.

No production login or automatic quiet hours. Staff decide when to begin contact.

A small, supervised pilot

Proposed next step for Lena and Carla

01 Agree on the operating rules

Walk through decline, timeout, and a late acceptance together. Confirm service durations, availability, and who updates Square.

02 Prepare for real clients

Add secure staff access and private client links. Connect a real texting provider and check that retries do not send duplicate messages.

03 Try a two-week pilot

Lena and Carla supervise each opening and keep Square current. Pause the pilot if a conflicting confirmation occurs.

What to measure

Refill rate

Filled openings divided by last-minute cancellations entered.
Target: at least half.

Staff effort and trust

Track manual follow-ups and any conflicting confirmations. Review the results together.